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Purpose

This procedure describe the actions the Wimmera CMA will undertake to ensure risks associated with exposure to UV radiation and extremes of weather are identified and control measures implemented to eliminate / reduce these risks.

References

Occupational Health and Safety Act 2004

Procedure

Wimmera CMA works coordinators / supervisors will monitor forecasted adverse weather conditions and, in consultation with the relevant Health and Safety Representative, will conduct a risk assessment to identify employees and / or work situations that have a high risk of exposure to solar UV radiation or the affects of adverse weather conditions.

Particular caution should be taken during the September to April period when solar UV radiation levels are at their most intense (particularly between the hours of 10.00am and 2.00pm or 11.00am and 3.00pm during daylight saving), and at other times when working near highly reflective surfaces such as metal roofing, concrete, water, glass, painted walls etc.

Appropriate control measures include:

- ⊙ Rescheduling of outdoor work to times of the day or year when high temperatures or extreme weather conditions, rain, high winds frost etc, are not forecast or are as prevalent
- ⊙ Supply and wearing of appropriate PPE; particularly clothing (as appropriate) with high levels of UVR protection, protection against wet weather and high visibility.
- ⊙ Use of 30+ UV protection sun screen
- ⊙ Staff rotation and increase of unscheduled breaks in order to reduce exposure
- ⊙ Providing shade and or cool easily accessible rest areas
- ⊙ Encourage workers to rest and to drink plenty of cool water for hydration when working in heat

Employees

- ⊙ Employees shall inform their works coordinator / supervisor if they are experiencing effects from working in inclement weather e.g., heat stress, sun burn, exposure, and complete an Incident Report form
- ⊙ Employees are required to adhere to the Personal Protective Equipment and Clothing Policy at all times when working outdoors.